

Package ‘breedRBayes’

September 3, 2026

Type Package

Title ASReml-Style Formula Front-End for the BGLR Bayesian Engine

Version 0.0.0.9000

Description A formula-based interface, inspired by 'asreml' and 'sommer', for fitting Bayesian mixed models with the 'BGLR' engine. Supports genomic prediction (GBLUP), random-regression / reaction-norm models, multi-trait models and factor-analytic structures. Provides extraction of posterior chains, variance components, heritabilities as full posterior distributions, and Markov-chain convergence diagnostics.

License MIT + file LICENSE

Encoding UTF-8

LazyData false

Depends R (>= 4.1.0)

Imports BGLR,
coda,
RhpcBLASctl,
stats,
utils,
ggplot2

Suggests SpATS,
EnvRtype,
parallel,
testthat (>= 3.0.0),
knitr,
rmarkdown

RoxygenNote 7.3.2

Roxygen list(markdown = TRUE)

Config/testthat/edition 3

Contents

as_mcmc [2](#)

bbglr	2
gebv	4
heritability	4
legendre_basis	5
mcmc_diag	6
parse_model	6
plot_posterior	7
plot_trace	8
pr	8
predict.breedRB_fit	9
solution	10
solve_SNP	11
varcomp	12

as_mcmc

Convert a fitted model's posterior draws to a coda object

Description

Reads the variance-component chains (and optionally the intercept mu) written by BGLR and returns them as a `coda::mcmc.list` (one component per chain), ready for `mcmc_diag()` or coda/bayesplot functions.

Usage

```
as_mcmc(x, ...)

## S3 method for class 'breedRB_fit'
as_mcmc(x, what = "varcomp", ...)
```

Arguments

x	A breedRB_fit.
...	Unused.
what	Which quantities to return: any of "varcomp" and "mu".

Value

A `coda::mcmc.list`.

bbglr	<i>Fit a Bayesian mixed model with the BGLR engine using asreml-style formulas</i>
-------	--

Description

Fit a Bayesian mixed model with the BGLR engine using asreml-style formulas

Usage

```
bbglr(
  fixed,
  random = NULL,
  residual = NULL,
  data,
  relmat = list(),
  nIter = 5000,
  burnIn = 1000,
  thin = 5,
  nChains = 1,
  seed = 123,
  saveAt = NULL,
  verbose = TRUE
)
```

Arguments

fixed	Two-sided formula for the fixed/mean part, e.g. <code>yield ~ 1 + env</code> . Use <code>cbind(t1, t2) ~ ...</code> for a multi-trait model.
random	One-sided formula of random terms, e.g. <code>~ vm(gen, G)</code> . Special functions: <code>vm(f, K)</code> genomic effect with relationship matrix <code>K</code> ; <code>mrk(f, M, method)</code> genomic effect from a marker matrix <code>M</code> that automatically fits GBLUP or RR-BLUP, whichever is cheaper (method is "auto", "GBLUP" or "RRBLUP"; "auto" picks GBLUP when markers $\geq$ genotypes, else RR-BLUP — the two are prediction-equivalent). Use <code>solve_SNP()</code> to obtain marker effects. <code>leg(x, n) / rr(x, n)</code> random regression of order <code>n</code> ; <code>fa(f, k) / rrc(f, k)</code> factor-analytic. Bare names are factors; <code>a:b</code> is an interaction.
residual	One-sided residual formula. <code>NULL/~units</code> = homogeneous; <code>~dsum(~units env)</code> = heterogeneous residual variances by env.
data	A data frame.
relmat	Named list of matrices referenced by <code>vm()</code> and <code>mrk()</code> . For <code>vm()</code> these are relationship / covariance matrices (<code>K</code> , not its inverse), with row/column names matching the factor levels. For <code>mrk()</code> the entry is a marker matrix with genotypes in rows (row names = genotype IDs) and markers in columns.
nIter, burnIn, thin	MCMC controls passed to BGLR.

nChains	Integer number of independent chains (distinct seeds). Enables Gelman-Rubin diagnostics when > 1 .
seed	Base random seed; chain c uses $\text{seed} + c - 1$.
saveAt	Directory for BGLR binary output. Defaults to a fresh temp dir.
verbose	Logical; print BGLR progress.

Value

An object of class `breedRB_fit`.

Examples

```
G <- readRDS(system.file("extdata", "kinship.matrix.rds", package = "breedRBayes"))
dat <- read.csv(system.file("extdata", "data_soy.csv", package = "breedRBayes"))
fit <- bbglr(yield ~ 1 + env, random = ~ vm(gen, G), data = dat,
             relmat = list(G = G), nIter = 2000, burnIn = 500, nChains = 2)
```

gebv

Posterior genomic estimated breeding values (GEBV)

Description

Deprecated. Use `solution()`, which extracts posterior solutions for any term (genomic `vm()` BLUPs, plain random-factor BLUPs, and fixed effects). `gebv(fit, term)` is equivalent to `solution(fit, term, type = "random")` with the value column renamed `gebv`.

It still works for a `vm()` genomic term for now, mapping the ridge coefficients back through the PC rotation (genetic value = $\text{PC} \%*\% \text{b}$).

Usage

```
gebv(fit, term = NULL, prob = 0.95)
```

Arguments

fit	A <code>breedRB_fit</code> (single-trait).
term	Genetic term identifier (label or key). Defaults to the first <code>vm()</code> term. For a non-genomic random effect use <code>solution()</code> instead.
prob	Central credible-interval mass (default 0.95).

Value

A data frame with ID, posterior `gebv` (mean), `sd`, `lower`, `upper`, ordered by decreasing `gebv`, with the pooled draws matrix (`nDraws` $\times$ `nLevel`) attached as attribute `"draws"`.

See Also

`solution()`, the general replacement.

Examples

```
head(gebv(fit))
```

heritability

Posterior distribution of heritability

Description

Computes narrow-sense (genomic) heritability for every MCMC draw, returning the full posterior distribution rather than a single point estimate:

$$h^2 = \sigma_{genetic}^2 / (\sigma_{genetic}^2 + \sum \sigma_{other}^2 + \sigma_e^2).$$

Usage

```
heritability(fit, genetic = NULL, denominator = NULL, prob = 0.95)
```

Arguments

<code>fit</code>	A <code>breedRB_fit</code> .
<code>genetic</code>	Character vector of genetic term identifiers (label or key) forming the numerator. Defaults to the <code>vm()</code> term(s).
<code>denominator</code>	Character vector of term identifiers summed in the denominator alongside <code>varE</code> . Defaults to all random terms.
<code>prob</code>	Central credible-interval mass (default 0.95).

Value

A list of class `breedRB_h2`: summary (mean/median/sd/CI) and draws (posterior vector of h^2).

Examples

```
h2 <- heritability(fit); h2$summary; hist(h2$draws)
```

legendre_basis	<i>Orthogonal / orthonormal Legendre polynomial basis on [-1, 1]</i>
----------------	--

Description

Constructs a Legendre polynomial basis evaluated at a numeric vector scaled to [-1, 1], up to a specified order, using the three-term recurrence. Optionally returns the orthonormal basis.

Usage

```
legendre_basis(x, order, orthonormal = FALSE)
```

Arguments

x	Numeric vector (already scaled to [-1, 1]) where the basis is evaluated.
order	Integer. Maximum polynomial degree. Returns columns for degrees 0..order.
orthonormal	Logical. If TRUE, applies orthonormal scaling to each degree.

Value

A numeric matrix $\text{length}(x) \times (\text{order} + 1)$; column j is the degree $j - 1$ polynomial.

Examples

```
legendre_basis(seq(-1, 1, length.out = 5), order = 3)
```

mcmc_diag	<i>Markov-chain convergence diagnostics for a fitted model</i>
-----------	--

Description

Summarises convergence of the variance-component chains: effective sample size, Geweke's z , and (when the fit has >1 chain) the Gelman-Rubin potential-scale-reduction factor ($\hat{R}$).

Usage

```
mcmc_diag(fit, what = "varcomp", plot = FALSE)
```

Arguments

fit	A <code>breedRB_fit</code> .
what	Passed to <code>as_mcmc()</code> (default "varcomp"; add "mu" to include the intercept).
plot	Logical. If TRUE, also render ggplot2 trace plots of the monitored chains (via <code>plot_trace()</code>) and attach the plot object to the returned data frame as the "plot" attribute. Default FALSE.

Value

A data frame with one row per monitored parameter: param, n_eff, geweke_z, and Rhat (NA for single-chain fits). When plot = TRUE, the corresponding ggplot is attached as attr(., "plot").

Examples

```
mcmc_diag(fit)
d <- mcmc_diag(fit, plot = TRUE) # prints trace plots
attr(d, "plot")                  # the ggplot object
```

parse_model	<i>Parse asreml-style fixed / random / residual formulas</i>
-------------	--

Description

Turns the three model formulas into an internal, engine-agnostic description used by [bbglr\(\)](#). Not usually called directly.

Usage

```
parse_model(fixed, random = NULL, residual = NULL)
```

Arguments

fixed	Two-sided formula for the mean/fixed part, e.g. <code>yield ~ 1 + env</code> . Multi-trait models use <code>cbind(t1, t2) ~ . . .</code> .
random	One-sided formula for random terms, e.g. <code>~ vm(gen, G) + env:vm(gen, G)</code> . NULL for none.
residual	One-sided residual formula. NULL (default) or <code>~ units</code> gives homogeneous residuals; <code>~ dsum(~units env)</code> gives heterogeneous residual variances by env.

Value

A `breedRB_terms` list: response, fixed, random, residual.

Examples

```
parse_model(yield ~ 1 + env, ~ vm(gen, G))
```

plot_posterior	<i>Posterior density plot of variance components or heritability</i>
----------------	--

Description

Posterior density plot of variance components or heritability

Usage

```
plot_posterior(x, ...)

## S3 method for class 'breedRB_fit'
plot_posterior(x, ...)

## S3 method for class 'breedRB_h2'
plot_posterior(x, ...)
```

Arguments

x	A breedRB_fit (variance components) or a breedRB_h2 object.
...	Unused.

Value

A ggplot object.

plot_trace	<i>Trace plots of the variance-component chains</i>
------------	---

Description

Trace plots of the variance-component chains

Usage

```
plot_trace(fit, what = "varcomp")
```

Arguments

fit	A breedRB_fit.
what	Passed to as_mcmc() .

Value

A ggplot object (iteration on x, value on y, one panel per parameter, coloured by chain).

pr

*Posterior probability of ranking in the top fraction***Description**

For a model term, compute the posterior probability that each level ranks among the best threshold fraction of levels. Working from the pooled posterior draws (see [solution\(\)](#)), each MCMC draw is ranked independently and the top $k = \text{round}(\text{threshold} \times n)$ levels are flagged; the reported probability is the fraction of draws in which a level is flagged. This is the Bayesian "probability of being in the top X" candidates by their whole posterior, not just their point estimate.

Usage

```
pr(fit, term = NULL, type = NULL, threshold = 0.2, higher = TRUE, pair = FALSE)
```

Arguments

fit	A <code>breedRB_fit</code> (single-trait).
term	Term identifier (label as written in the formula, e.g. "gen", or the internal key). If NULL, the first random term is used.
type	Optional; one of "random" or "fixed", validated against the term's actual role. For a fixed term fitted with treatment contrasts the reference level is not among the coefficients and is therefore excluded.
threshold	Selected fraction in (0, 1); 0.20 = top 20%. Ignored when <code>pair = TRUE</code> .
higher	Logical (default TRUE). If TRUE the "top" is the highest values (e.g. yield); set FALSE when smaller values are better. Ignored when <code>pair = TRUE</code> .
pair	Logical (default FALSE). If TRUE, return the pairwise table of posterior probabilities $P(A > B)$ for every pair of levels instead of the top-fraction summary.

Details

Because every draw is ranked on its own, adding the intercept `mu` would not change the ranking, so `pr()` is unaffected by centering.

Value

If `pair = FALSE`, a data frame with effect (level name), `solution` (posterior mean), and `prob` (posterior probability of ranking in the selected fraction), ordered by decreasing `prob`, with `k` and `threshold` attached as attributes. If `pair = TRUE`, a data frame with A, B, and `prob = P(A > B)` for every unordered pair, where A is the member with the larger posterior mean (so `prob >= 0.5` for well-separated pairs), ordered by decreasing `prob`.

See Also

[solution\(\)](#) for the underlying posterior draws.

Examples

```
# probability each genotype is in the top 20%
pr(fit, term = "gen", type = "random", threshold = 0.20)
# pairwise probabilities P(A > B)
pr(fit, term = "gen", type = "random", pair = TRUE)
```

predict.breedRB_fit	<i>Predict genomic values for new genotypes from their markers</i>
---------------------	--

Description

Scores genotypes that were **not** in the training data by combining the posterior marker effects with the new genotypes' marker calls:

$$\hat{g}_{new} = M_{c,new} b,$$

where $M_{c,new}$ is M_{new} centred by the **training** column means (so the new genotypes sit on the same scale as the fitted breeding values) and b are the per-draw marker effects (read directly for a RR-BLUP fit, back-solved for a GBLUP fit — see [solve_SNP\(\)](#)). The full posterior is propagated, so every returned prediction carries a credible interval.

Usage

```
## S3 method for class 'breedRB_fit'
predict(object, M_new, term = NULL, add_mu = TRUE, prob = 0.95, ...)
```

Arguments

object	A breedRB_fit (single-trait) with a mrk() genomic term.
M_new	Marker matrix for the genotypes to predict: genotype IDs in the row names, markers in columns. Must contain every marker used in the fit (extra columns are ignored; column order need not match). May include training genotypes, in which case the prediction reproduces their fitted value.
term	Genomic term identifier (label or key). Defaults to the first genomic term.
add_mu	Logical (default TRUE). Add the model intercept mu to every draw, putting predictions on the overall-mean (phenotype) scale rather than the deviation scale. Done per posterior draw, so mu's uncertainty enters the interval.
prob	Central credible-interval mass (default 0.95).
...	Unused; for S3 compatibility.

Details

This requires a marker-based mrk() term. A vm() fit holds only a relationship matrix and cannot score genotypes outside it; refit the genomic term as mrk(gen, M) to enable prediction.

Value

A data frame with ID, prediction (posterior mean), sd, lower, upper, ordered by decreasing prediction, with the pooled draws matrix (nDraws x nGenotype) attached as attribute "draws".

See Also

`solve_SNP()`, `solution()`.

Examples

```
fit <- bbglr(y ~ 1, random = ~ mrk(gen, M), data = dat, relmat = list(M = M))
pred <- predict(fit, M_new, add_mu = TRUE) # score unobserved genotypes
head(pred)
```

solution	<i>Posterior solutions (BLUPs / fixed effects) for a model term</i>
----------	---

Description

Extracts the posterior distribution of the effect solutions for any term in a fitted model, pooled across chains:

- **Random terms** return BLUPs. A `vm()` genomic term is back-mapped through its principal-component rotation to per-genotype values (identical to `gebv()`); a plain random factor (fitted without a relationship matrix) returns one solution per level; random regression / covariate terms return one solution per basis coefficient.
- **Fixed terms** return the posterior of each estimable coefficient (treatment contrasts; the reference level is the implicit baseline at 0).

Usage

```
solution(fit, term = NULL, type = NULL, prob = 0.95, add_mu = FALSE)
```

Arguments

<code>fit</code>	A <code>breedRB_fit</code> (single-trait).
<code>term</code>	Term identifier (the label as written in the formula, e.g. "gen" or "env", or the internal key). If <code>NULL</code> , the first random term is used.
<code>type</code>	Optional; one of "random" or "fixed". When supplied it is validated against the term's actual role (a mismatch is an error), which is a convenient guard when a name could be ambiguous.
<code>prob</code>	Central credible-interval mass (default 0.95).
<code>add_mu</code>	Logical (default <code>FALSE</code>). If <code>TRUE</code> , the model intercept <code>mu</code> is added to every draw, shifting the solutions onto the overall-mean scale (e.g. BLUP + <code>mu</code>). Most useful for random BLUPs; the addition is done per posterior draw so the credible intervals account for uncertainty in <code>mu</code> .

Value

A data frame with effect (level / coefficient name), solution (posterior mean), sd, lower, upper. Random-term rows are ordered by decreasing solution; fixed-term rows keep design order. The pooled draws matrix (nDraws × nEffect) is attached as attribute "draws", and the resolved role as attribute "type".

See Also

[gebv\(\)](#) for genomic breeding values from a `vm()` term.

Examples

```
solution(fit, term = "gen", type = "random")           # random BLUPs (no G matrix)
solution(fit, term = "gen", type = "random", add_mu = TRUE) # BLUP + mu
solution(fit, term = "env", type = "fixed")           # fixed-effect estimates
```

solve_SNP

Marker (SNP) effects from a genomic model

Description

Recovers the posterior distribution of per-marker allele-substitution effects b on the centred-marker scale, such that the genomic breeding values satisfy $GEV = M_c b$ (where M_c is the column-centred marker matrix). This lets a **GBLUP** fit — which estimates breeding values rather than marker effects — be back-transformed to marker effects:

$$b = M_c^\top (M_c M_c^\top)^{-1} u$$

applied to every posterior draw of the breeding values u . For a **RR-BLUP** fit (`mrk()` chose RR-BLUP because genotypes outnumbered markers) the marker effects are estimated directly and are simply rescaled and returned.

Usage

```
solve_SNP(fit, M = NULL, term = NULL, prob = 0.95)
```

Arguments

<code>fit</code>	A <code>breedRB_fit</code> (single-trait) with a <code>vm()</code> or <code>mrk()</code> genomic term.
<code>M</code>	Marker matrix with genotypes in rows (row names matching the genotype IDs) and markers in columns. Only needed to override the training markers when back-solving a GBLUP fit; for a <code>mrk()</code> fit the training markers stored in the fit are used automatically, and a RR-BLUP fit ignores <code>M</code> .
<code>term</code>	Genomic term identifier (label or key). Defaults to the first genomic term.
<code>prob</code>	Central credible-interval mass (default 0.95).

Details

The back-transform requires $M_c M_c^\top$ to be invertible, which holds when the number of markers is at least the number of genotypes — exactly the regime in which `mrk()` selects GBLUP.

Value

A data frame with marker, effect (posterior mean), sd, lower, upper, in marker (design) order, with the pooled draws matrix (nDraws x nMarker) attached as attribute "draws" and the fitted method as attribute "method".

See Also

`predict.breedRB_fit()` to score new genotypes, `solution()`.

Examples

```
snp <- solve_SNP(fit)      # marker effects (back-solved for GBLUP, direct for RR-BLUP)
head(snp[order(-abs(snp$effect)), ])
```

varcomp

Posterior variance components of a fitted model

Description

Returns the posterior distribution and summaries of every random-term variance and the residual variance, pooling all chains.

Usage

```
varcomp(fit, prob = 0.95, draws = FALSE)
```

Arguments

<code>fit</code>	A <code>breedRB_fit</code> .
<code>prob</code>	Central credible-interval mass (default 0.95).
<code>draws</code>	Logical; if TRUE also return the pooled posterior draws matrix.

Value

A data frame of per-component summaries (term, mean, median, sd, lower, upper), with the pooled draws attached as attribute "draws" when `draws = TRUE`.

Examples

```
varcomp(fit)
```